

WILDLIFE INTAKE REGULATIONS & ADMISSION PROTOCOLS

Statutory Framework and Mandatory Screening Criteria for Permitted Rehabilitation Sites

STATUTORY REGULATORY LAW: Wildlife rehabilitation facilities operate under strict state (e.g., California Department of Fish and Wildlife) and federal (U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service) permit oversight. Unauthorized processing, treatment, or retention of protected wild animals outside specific permit parameters is a severe misdemeanor violation.

1. Strict Screening & Legal Origin Validation

- **Mandatory Point-of-Extraction Log:** The surrendering party must supply the exact street location, city, and county of original animal extraction. Relocating wild animals across disparate bio-regions is illegal.
- **Kidnapping Prevention Interview:** Healthy, uninjured baby wildlife brought in by the public must undergo rigorous screening. If the animal was healthy and normal for its development stage (e.g., fledgling birds), the presenter must be directed to return the animal immediately to its original site for parental reunification.

2. Species Admission Matrix & Action Paths

WILDLIFE CATEGORY	REGULATORY FRAMEWORK	IMMEDIATE ACTION PLAN
Protected & Migratory Birds	Governed by the federal Migratory Bird Treaty Act (MBTA). Includes songbirds, shorebirds, and all raptors.	Accept immediately. Isolate visually from all domestic species. Coordinate specialized aviary routing.
Rabies Vector Species (RVS) (Raccoons, Skunks, Bats, Foxes)	High-risk transmission vectors. Subject to stringent localized health department containment tracking.	Bypass public counters. Transfer immediately to specialized RVS-permitted isolation suites. Staff must wear heavy double leathers.
State Special Status Species	Threatened, endangered, or dynamic predatory mammals (e.g., mountain lions, adult coyotes, eagles).	Stabilize immediate life-threatening metrics and report within 24 hours to the State Wildlife Agency.

3. Disease Quarantine & Biosecurity Controls

- **Strict Cross-Species Isolation:** Wild animals must never be housed or processed in lines of sight or scent proximity to domestic domestic species (dogs, cats). This prevents lethal virus cross-contamination (such as domestic canine distemper spreading to wild raccoons).
- **Avian Influenza Protocols:** Waterfowl or corvids showing respiratory or severe neurological markers must undergo immediate threshold testing before entering general rehabilitation environments.